

Word family: **rhythm / rhythms / rhythmic / rhythmically**

Base word: rhythm

Plural: rhythms

Related forms: rhythmic, rhythmically

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / related adjective and adverb forms (相關形容詞及副詞)

Your sentence:

> “I remember the greenish shell, the gentle eyes, and the quiet **rhythm** of its body as it disappeared into the blue water.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **rhythm** means a **regular, flowing pattern of movement**.

The speaker is describing the sea turtle's body moving in a calm, repeated, graceful way.

繁體中文： **動作有規律地重複、起伏或流動所形成的節奏；律動**

中文翻譯：

> “...the quiet **rhythm** of its body...”

「.....牠身體那種安靜而有規律的**節奏 / 律動**.....」

Here:

rhythm of its body = 身體移動時平穩、有規律的律動

1. **rhythm = regular pattern of sound/beats (音樂 / 聲音) — 節奏；韻律**

This is the central and most familiar meaning.

Meaning: A regular or organized pattern of beats, sounds, or stresses.

Practice 1

> “The song has a strong **rhythm**.”

「這首歌有很強的**節奏感**。」

Practice 2

> “She tapped her foot to the ****rhythm**** of the music.”

「她隨着音樂的****節奏****踏腳。」

****rhythm = 聲音、拍子、重音等按一定規律排列所形成的節奏****

Common:

- * musical rhythm
- * strong rhythm
- * steady rhythm
- * rhythm of a song

2. ****rhythm = regular pattern of movement (動作) — 律動；節奏****

This is the meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** A repeated, flowing, or regular pattern in the way something moves.

Practice 3 — Original

> “I remember the quiet ****rhythm**** of its body.”

「我記得牠身體安靜而有規律的****律動****。」

Practice 4

> “The dancers moved in a smooth ****rhythm****.”

「舞者以流暢的****節奏 / 律動****移動。」

Practice 5

> “Her breathing settled into a slow ****rhythm****.”

「她的呼吸逐漸變成緩慢而穩定的****節奏****。」

****rhythm = 動作、呼吸或身體活動以規律方式重複所形成的律動****

This is closely related to the musical sense, but the medium changes from sound to movement.

For strict counting, I would merge them under one broad concept:

> ****regular repeated pattern****

while still showing both because the learner-facing Chinese differs.

3. **rhythm** = regular pattern in natural processes (自然 / 生理) — 節律；週期

Rhythm can describe regular recurring patterns in nature or the body.

Practice 6

> “The body follows a natural sleep **rhythm**.”

「身體有自然的睡眠**節律**。」

Practice 7

> “The seasons create a yearly **rhythm**.”

「四季形成每年的自然**週期 / 節律**。」

rhythm = 自然現象或身體功能按固定時間 / 規律反覆出現的模式

Common:

- * sleep rhythm
- * biological rhythm
- * daily rhythm
- * seasonal rhythm

This is a domain extension of the same recurring-pattern concept.

4. **rhythm** = pattern/flow of activity or life (生活 / 工作) — 節奏；步調

Rhythm can describe the pace and recurring pattern of everyday life, work, study, etc.

Practice 8

> “It took me a while to get back into the **rhythm** of work.”

「我花了一點時間才重新適應工作的**節奏**。」

Practice 9

> “The city has its own **rhythm**.”

「這座城市有自己獨特的**步調 / 節奏**。」

rhythm = 生活、工作、活動等持續進行時形成的規律步調

This is a common figurative extension.

5. **rhythm** = pattern of language/speech (語言) — 韻律 ; 節奏

In language, **rhythm** refers to how stressed and unstressed syllables, pauses, and timing are patterned.

Practice 10

> “English has a different **rhythm** from Cantonese.”

「英語和廣東話有不同的語音**節奏 / 韻律**。」

Practice 11

> “The poem has a gentle **rhythm**.”

「這首詩有柔和的**韻律**。」

rhythm = 語音、詩歌或句子中重音、停頓和長短所形成的節奏模式

This is distinct enough as a language/poetry domain use to show explicitly.

6. **rhythm** = regular repeated pattern in visual design (視覺 / 設計) — 視覺節奏

In art and design, **rhythm** can describe repeated shapes, lines, colours, or visual elements.

Practice 12

> “The repeated arches create a strong visual **rhythm**.”

「重複的拱門形成很強的視覺**節奏**。」

Practice 13

> “The pattern gives the design a natural **rhythm**.”

「這個圖案令設計產生自然的視覺**律動**。」

****rhythm = 視覺元素有規律地重複，產生流動感和連續感****

This is a useful design-domain extension of the same repeated-pattern concept.

Related form: ****rhythmic****

****Rhythmic**** means having a regular, repeated pattern or rhythm.

Practice 14

> “The turtle moved with a slow, ****rhythmic**** motion.”

「海龜以緩慢而有****節奏的****動作游動。」

Practice 15

> “We could hear the ****rhythmic**** sound of the waves.”

「我們可以聽到海浪有****規律節奏的****聲音。」

****rhythmic = 具有規律重複節奏或律動的****

Related form: ****rhythmically****

Practice 16

> “The lights flashed ****rhythmically****.”

「燈光有****節奏地****閃爍。」

Practice 17

> “She moved ****rhythmically**** with the music.”

「她隨着音樂有****節奏地****移動。」

****rhythmically = 以有規律、有節奏的方式****

Important distinction: **rhythm vs beat**

beat

usually means the individual pulse or repeated unit in music.

rhythm

means the larger pattern formed by beats, stresses, and timing.

So:

beat = 拍子 / 節拍單位

rhythm = 節奏模式

A rhythm is made up of beats, but is not the same thing as one beat.

Important distinction: **rhythm vs tempo**

tempo

means how fast or slow the music is.

rhythm

means the pattern of beats and timing.

A song can keep the same rhythm but change tempo.

So:

tempo = 速度

rhythm = 節奏模式

Important distinction: **rhythm vs pace**

pace

focuses on speed.

rhythm

focuses on repeated pattern and flow.

> “The pace of work is fast.”

= 工作速度很快。

> “The rhythm of work is steady.”

= 工作步調有規律。

Important distinction: **rhythm vs routine**

routine

means a regular sequence of activities or habits.

rhythm

means the flow/pattern created by repeated activity.

> morning routine

= 早晨固定程序

> rhythm of daily life

= 日常生活的步調

They overlap, but **rhythm** is more about flow than fixed tasks.

Important distinction: **rhythm vs pattern**

pattern

is the broad word for any repeated or organized arrangement.

rhythm

usually emphasizes:

- * repetition through time
- * movement
- * sound
- * flow

So:

> visual pattern

is broader.

> visual rhythm

emphasizes repeated elements creating movement/flow.

Countability note

****Rhythm**** can be countable:

- > a rhythm
- > different rhythms

but also appears more generally:

> “She has good rhythm.”

Here it refers to an overall sense/ability rather than one specific pattern.

This is useful for learners.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

- * ****rhythm****
- * ****rhythms****
- * ****rhythmic****
- * ****rhythmically****

Useful constructions include:

- * musical rhythm
- * rhythm of movement
- * biological rhythm
- * daily rhythm
- * rhythm of speech
- * visual rhythm
- * get into a rhythm

The Golden Manual says common domain extensions should be checked, but when the same underlying semantic idea — here, **regular repeated pattern** — explains them, they should be merged rather than artificially multiplied.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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rhythm — sound/music	聲音、拍子、重音等按規律排列所形成的節奏
rhythm — movement/body	動作、呼吸或身體活動有規律地重複所形成的律動
rhythm — natural/biological cycle	自然現象或身體功能按固定規律反覆出現的節律
rhythm — life/activity flow	生活、工作或活動持續進行時形成的規律步調
rhythm — speech/poetry	語言、詩歌中重音、停頓和時間安排形成的韻律
rhythm — visual design	視覺元素有規律地重複而形成的流動感 / 視覺節奏
rhythmic	具有規律節奏或律動的
rhythmically	以有規律、有節奏的方式

For your original sentence

> “...the quiet ****rhythm**** of its body...”

The exact meaning is:

****rhythm = 海龜身體游動時反覆、平順、有規律的動作模式****

So:

> ****the quiet rhythm of its body****

= ****牠身體安靜、平穩而有規律的律動****

For your database, I would count ****3 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****rhythm****:

1. ****regular repeated pattern in sound or movement****
2. ****regular recurring pattern in natural, biological, or daily activity****
3. ****structured flow/pattern in language, poetry, or visual design****

I would keep the turtle's movement under #1, merge biological/daily cycles under #2, and treat speech/poetry/design as established domain extensions under #3 rather than inflate the count.